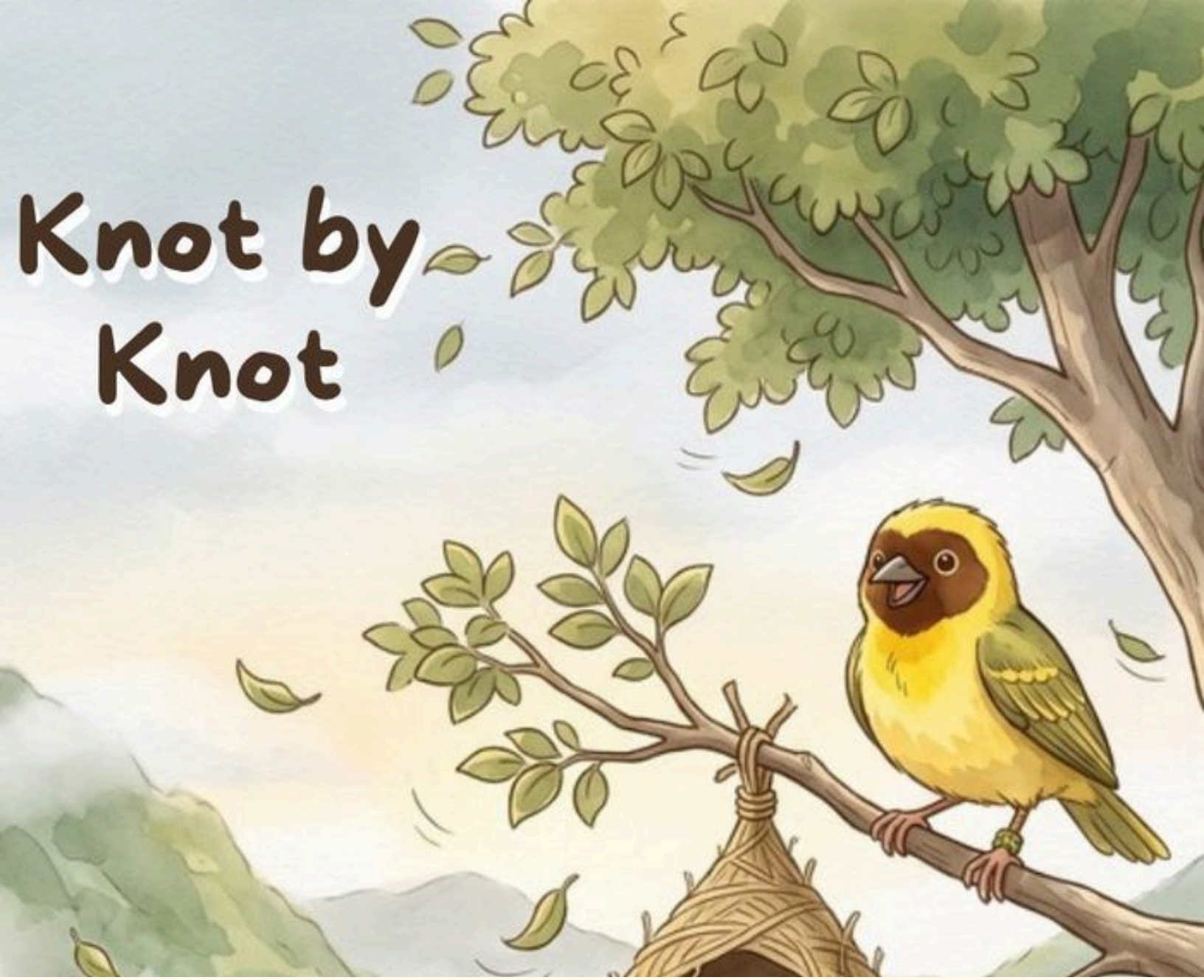


Home activity pack, ages 3 to 7

Knot by Knot

Twelve pages to color, cut, trace, make and talk about, all from the story.
The value in this book: doing it well.

For use in your own home. Please don't share the file or post it online.

For grown-ups

Read the story first, then pick one page a day. Each page takes 10 to 20 minutes. There are no wrong answers.

The big idea

Do your work with care, and then finish it. Rushing makes weak work, and waiting for perfect means it never gets done.

Say it together

Loop, pull, tug!

Five words from the story

Word	What it means	Do it
weave	to cross strips over and under to make something	wiggle one hand through the fingers of the other
knot	a tight twist that holds string or grass together	make two fists and pull them apart
sag	to droop down in the middle	let your arms flop down
crooked	not straight, a bit bent	bend your finger sideways
finish	to get to the very end	brush your hands together: done!

A gentle note

Some children feel big worry about mistakes. Keep the message gentle: crooked knots are fine, and finishing is something to be proud of.

Never shame speed or slowness. Both Zayn and the children are learning a balance.

What you need

Crayons, a pencil, scissors, glue or tape, a few craft sticks or straws, and the book (or read it free on screen at doubleadventure.ca).

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Meet the friends

Cut out each card along the dashed line. Tape a craft stick on the back and you have a puppet. Act out the story!



Zayn

Rüppell's weaver

The fastest beak in the colony, learning to build well



Hana

Arabian chameleon

The careful friend: grip, test, step



Rima

Weaver chick

Zayn's little sister, who needs a snug nest

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How did they feel?

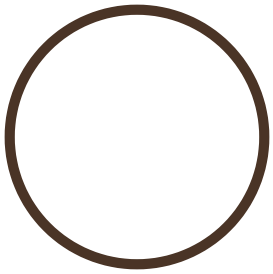
Feelings change during a story. Talk about each moment, then draw how the character felt.

Moment 1

Zayn is always finished first: Zip, zip, done!

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

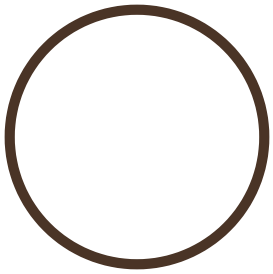


Moment 2

Zayn keeps untying crooked knots.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

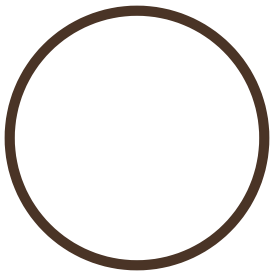


Moment 3

The wind blows all night; every knot holds.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm



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Story in order

Color the pictures. Write 1, 2 and 3 in the boxes to show what happened first, next and last. Then cut them out and tell the story.



Color me ☐



Color me ☐



Color me ☐

Tell it in your own words

First, _____

Then, _____

At the end, _____

For grown-ups: the pictures come from the start, the middle and the end of the book. Younger children can just point and tell.

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Trace the words

Trace each word with a pencil. Then try writing it on your own in the empty space.

weave to cross strips over and under to make something

weave weave

knot a tight twist that holds string or grass together

knot knot

sag to droop down in the middle

sag sag

Zayn the hero of the story

Zayn Zayn

Write your name

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Draw your own story

Zayn showed doing it well. Draw a time when you showed doing it well too, or a time you could.



Tell a grown-up: What happened? How did you feel? How did the other person feel?

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Make and do

Pick one to try today. Each one comes straight from the story.

Paper weaving

You need: Card with slits, paper strips

Children weave strips over and under, saying ‘loop, pull, tug’ as they go. Stop together after ten minutes and ask: Is it strong? Is it finished? Then finish it. Display the mats ‘crooked bits and all’.

Loop, pull, tug

Weave strips of paper or wool through a fork or a paper plate. Is your second try neater than your first?

Grip, test, step

Walk along a line on the floor like Hana: grip, test, step. Slow and careful, all the way to the end.

Chameleon eyes

Cover one eye and look around, then the other. A chameleon can use each eye separately all the time!

Draw what you made

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The real animals

The animals in Knot by Knot are based on real ones. Here is something true about each of them.



Zayn

Rüppell's weaver

Scientists filmed weaver birds building nest after nest. The more nests a bird built, the fewer blades of grass it dropped. Building is a skill they learn, just like Zayn!



Hana

Arabian chameleon

A chameleon's eyes swivel separately: one can look up and left while the other looks down and right. When she spots a bug, both eyes lock on it.



Rima

Weaver chick

About two weeks in the egg, then about 18 days in the nest, and the chick is ready to leave home. Less than five weeks in all!

Story or real?

Real weavers really do get better with practice. But a real male weaver builds his nest to win a mate, not for his little sister. And the green grass ring on Zayn's leg is our artist's idea.

Where they really live

Zayn's hill is in Dhofar, in the south of Oman. Every summer from late June to late September, the khareef brings drizzle and fog, and the dry hills turn bright green.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/knot-by-knot

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Color the story

Color this page from the book. What is happening here?



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Talk together cards

Cut out the cards and keep them in a jar. Pull one out at dinner, in the car or at bedtime.

What is the little bird making? How do you think it does that with only a beak?

Knot by Knot, talk card 1

What happened to Zayn's first nest? Why?

Knot by Knot, talk card 2

How did weaving slowly feel to Zayn?

Knot by Knot, talk card 3

Why did he keep untying his knots?

Knot by Knot, talk card 4

What helped him finish?

Knot by Knot, talk card 5

What is something you can do well and finish this week?

Knot by Knot, talk card 6

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Doing it well hero

This is to say that

_____

showed doing it well, just like Zayn.

Loop, pull, tug!

Signed _____ Date _____

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